

Copywriting for Business: Beginner's Guide

Lesson 6: Copy for Different Business Channels

Copy for Different Business Channels – Study Notes

Key Concepts

1. **Channel specific tone & format** – How voice, length, and structure change for web pages, emails, ads, and social media.
2. **Audience intent per channel** – What the reader is looking to do (research, purchase, be entertained) and how that guides copy.
3. **Core message consistency** – Keeping the main offer, value proposition, and CTA identical while adapting the surrounding copy.
4. **Technical constraints** – Character limits, headline hierarchy, image text ratios, and platform guidelines.
5. **Testing & optimization** – Using A/B tests and analytics to refine copy for each channel.

Summary

Effective marketing copy must speak the language of each channel while delivering a single, unified offer. A website page can afford longer, SEO friendly copy that educates and builds trust; an email needs a personal, direct voice that nudges the subscriber toward a clear CTA; a paid ad must capture attention in seconds with a punchy headline and a compelling hook; and a social media post should be concise, conversational, and optimized for sharing.

The key is to distill the offer into its essential elements—what the product is, the primary benefit, and the call to action—and then repackage those elements to fit the format, tone, and audience expectations of each channel. By doing so, you maintain brand consistency, reinforce the message across touchpoints, and increase the likelihood that prospects will move through the funnel regardless of where they encounter the copy.

Important Points

- **Identify the channel's primary goal**
 - Web: inform & rank !' SEO rich, detailed.
 - Email: convert !' personal, time sensitive.
 - Ads: capture !' headline first, visual driven.
 - Social: engage !' bite size, shareable.
- **Adjust length and structure**
 - Web: 300–1500 words, sub headings, bullet lists.
 - Email: 150–250 words, clear subject line, preview text.
 - Ads: "d90 characters for headline, "d30 for description (Google), "d125 for Facebook primary text.
 - Social: 1–2 sentences + hashtag/emoji for platforms like Instagram/Twitter.

- **Tone & voice**
 - Web: authoritative yet approachable.
 - Email: conversational, sometimes informal (depending on list).
 - Ads: urgent, benefit focused, sometimes bold or witty.
 - Social: relaxed, community oriented, may include slang/emoji.
- **CTA placement**
 - Web: multiple CTAs (top, middle, bottom).
 - Email: one primary CTA button, reinforced by a text link.
 - Ads: CTA button built in (e.g., “Shop Now”).
 - Social: CTA in caption + link in bio or swipe up.
- **Maintain core copy**
 - Offer name, discount amount, deadline, and guarantee should stay identical across all versions.
- **Compliance & platform rules**
 - Disclosures (e.g., “Free trial, then \$X/month”) must appear where required, especially in ads and email subject lines.

Examples

Example Offer

“Get 30 % off the Premium Planner – limited to the first 200 buyers. Use code SAVE30.”

| Channel | Adapted Copy | Why It Works |

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| **Web Landing Page** | **Headline:** “Upgrade Your Year with the Premium Planner – 30 % Off Today!”
Sub headline: “Organize, prioritize, and achieve your goals. Only 200 spots available.”
Body: 3 paragraph story about how the planner transforms productivity, bullet list of features, testimonial, **CTA button:** “Claim My Discount”. | Long form copy allows SEO keywords (“premium planner”) and builds trust with details and social proof. Multiple CTAs guide the reader. |

| **Email** | **Subject:** “Your 30 % Planner Discount Inside – 200 Spots Only!”
Preheader: “Don’t miss out – upgrade your planning game.”
Body: Friendly greeting, short benefit paragraph, bold “SAVE30” code, **CTA button:** “Grab My Planner”. | Subject line is urgent and personalized; concise body respects inbox time; CTA button stands out. |

| **Google Search Ad** | **Headline 1:** “30 % Off Premium Planner”
Headline 2: “Only 200 Spots – Act Fast!”
Description: “Organize your year. Use code SAVE30. Free shipping.” | Maxes character limits, front loads the offer, includes a call to action phrase (“Act Fast”). |

| **Instagram Post** | **Image:** Photo of the planner on a desk.
Caption: “(Ready to level up your planning? 30 % off the Premium Planner for the first 200 buyers. Use code **SAVE30**. Link in bio! #PlanToWin #Productivity” | Visual first, short and punchy, uses emojis and hashtags to boost discoverability; directs to bio link. |

Quick Review

1. What are the three main elements that must stay consistent across all channel copies?
2. How does audience intent differ between a website page and a paid ad?
3. Give an example of how you would shorten a 150 word email body for a Twitter post.
4. Why is it important to place multiple CTAs on a landing page but only one on an email?

5. List two platform specific constraints you must consider when writing ad copy.

Further Reading

- **Copywriting for SEO:** How to blend keywords with persuasive language.
- **Email Marketing Best Practices:** Subject line formulas and deliverability tips.
- **Social Media Algorithms:** Why engagement metrics affect copy strategy.
- **Conversion Rate Optimization (CRO):** A/B testing frameworks for headlines and CTAs.
- **Legal Disclosures in Advertising:** FTC guidelines for offers and promotions.

